Derek Wakefield

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EMPLOYMENT

2025- **Assistant Professor**, Department of Political Science, Bucknell University

2023-2025 **Postdoctoral Fellow**, Department of Political Science, Emory University

EDUCATION

2023 Ph.D. in Politics and Social Policy, **Princeton University**

Dissertation: *Misengaged, Not Disengaged: How Campaigns Persuade Latino Voters with Economic Messaging* (defended in August 2023)

Committee: Tali Mendelberg (chair), LaFleur Stephens-Dougan, Ismail White, Michael Jones-Correa (University of Pennsylvania)

2016 B.A. in Political Science (major) and Feminist Studies (minor), **University of California Santa Barbara**

Graduated with High Honors and Distinction

Honors Thesis: *Understanding Latino Politics in Austin, Texas*.

Advisors: Pei-te Lien, Lorraine McDonnell, Volker Welter

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Wakefield, Derek, Bernard Fraga, and Colin Fisk. (2025) "Partisan Change with Generational Turnover: Latino Party Identification from 1989 to 2023." *Journal of Race, Ethnicity, and Politics*. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1017/rep.2025.31

Wakefield, Derek. (2025) "It's the Economy: The Effect of Economic Policy Appeals on Latino Independents." *Political Behavior*. DOI: 10.1007/s11109-025-10004-y

RESEARCH

Topics of Interest

Latino politics, American politics, political behavior, race and ethnic politics, political psychology, political communication, experiments, surveys, mixed methods

Working Papers

Wakefield, Derek. "Non-Ideological Latinos: Disengagement, Identity, and the Limits of the Moderate-as-Swing-Voter Frame." Under review, Journal of Race, Ethnicity, and Politics.

Wakefield, Derek, Tyler Reny, Joshua Dyck, and Gregg Johnson. "Bringing Retrospection Back In: How the Economy Shapes Latino Voting in the US"

Valenzuela, Ali, **Derek Wakefield**, and Chris Flores. "Who's Targeting Latinos? How Democrats and Republicans Use Latino Identity Cues in Televised Campaign Ads from 2000-

2016"

Wakefield, Derek. "How the Young Lords Represent a Radical Latino Panethnic Identity"

Wakefield, Derek, and Charlotte Lipman. "Where the Rinks Aren't: Race, Capital, and the Geography of Public Skating Infrastructure in Seven U.S. Metropolitan Areas."

HONORS AND AWARDS

2023 Honorable Mention, MPSA Latino Politics Caucus Best Graduate Student Paper Award for presented paper "Not Just Ethnic Voters: The Effect of Economic and Immigration Appeals on Latinos."

2022 Best of Access, Diversity and Inclusion (BADI) Awards by Princeton Graduate School Office of Access, Diversity, and Inclusion. Awarded for co-founding student group "Students of Color and Allies" in 2019 with Sonya Chen, Sonny Kim, and Rikio Inouye.

2020 Princeton University Teaching Award for Introduction to American Politics (Spring 2020). Awarded to Politics Ph.D. students who made a "significant and exceptional contribution to undergraduate teaching."

GRANTS AND FELLOWSHIPS

2025 Bucknell University Startup Fund, $30,000

2022 Princeton Research in Experimental Social Science (PRESS) Student Grant, $1500

2021 PRESS Student Grant, $1500

Mamdouha S. Bobst Multi-Center Dissertation Grant, $3400

Center for the Study of Democratic Politics (CSDP) Dissertation Grant, $5000

2019 PRESS Student Grant, $1000

PRESENTATIONS AND INVITED TALKS

Conferences and Invited Talks

2026 Southern Political Science Association

2025 Southern Political Science Association

Midwestern Political Science Association

2024 University of Colorado, Boulder Race and Ethnic Politics Lab

American Political Science Association

Mobilizing Low Propensity Voters Conference at University of Houston

Western Political Science Association

Midwestern Political Science Association

2023 American Political Science Association

Political Psychology Lab at University of California, Los Angeles (October 8, 2023)

Symposium on Immigration, Race and Ethnicity (SPIRE) at Yale University (September 28, 2023)

Western Political Science Association

Midwestern Political Science Association

The Politics of Race, Immigration, and Ethnicity Consortium (PRIEC) at Arizona State University (January 20, 2023)

2022 University of Missouri, S. Truman Research Group for Immigration and Political Economy (November 15, 2022)

Indiana University at Bloomington, American Politics Workshop (November 1, 2022)

Western Political Science Association

Midwestern Political Science Association

2018 American Political Science Association, Latino Caucus

Other Presentations

2024 "Introduction to R" for the APSA Committee on the Status of Graduate Students

2018-2023 American Politics Graduate Research Seminar, Princeton University

2020-2022 "Experiments 101: How to Run a Survey Experiment" for PRESS

2019-2021 "Conjoint Experiments in Qualtrics" for PRESS

2019-2021 Princeton Research in Experimental Social Science (PRESS) Workshop

MEDIA AND PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT

Interviews

2026 ZDF (German public television), interview with correspondent Salim Sadat, October 21

WHYY (Philadelphia NPR), *Studio 2*, "Will Latino Voters Swing Back to Democrats?" October 5

CNHI News, "Latinos Viewed as Key Swing Vote in Midterms," by Christian M. Wade, syndicated nationally, September

2025 Deutsche Welle, "¿Se arrepienten latinos en EE. UU. de haber votado a Trump?" online article, February 15

The Latino Vote podcast with Chuck Rocha and Mike Madrid, "Kitchen Table Issues: A Look at Latino Independent Voters," February 7

Equis Labs, with Carlos Odio and Rachel Stein Valenzuela

Coverage

2026 *The Latin Times*, "Allentown's Latino Vote Could Flip the House. Here's What's at Stake," October

Press Release Coverage

2026 *Standard-Journal* (Milton, PA), "Political Scientist Assesses Latino Voting Bloc," August 31

NorthcentralPA.com, "Bucknell Political Scientist: Latino Voting Bloc Likely to Swing Hard," August 29

OTHER ACADEMIC EXPERIENCE

2021-2023 Graduate Consultant of Princeton Research in Experimental Social Science

2017-2021 Graduate Coordinator of Princeton Research in Experimental Social Science

2017-2019 Research Assistant for Ali Valenzuela

TEACHING

Bucknell University

Fall 2026 POL 140: Introduction to American Politics

Spring 2026 POL 140: Introduction to American Politics

POL 296: Quantitative Analysis

Fall 2025 POL 140: Introduction to American Politics

POL 246: Race and Ethnic Politics in the US

Emory University

2024/2025 POL 394/585: Introduction to Data Analysis using R (undergraduate and graduate)

2023 POL 347: Latinx Politics (undergraduate), co-instructor with Professor Bernard Fraga

Princeton University

2022 POL 325: The Presidency and the Executive, TA for Dr. Lauren Wright

2021 POL 506: Qualitative Methods, TA for Professor Layna Mosley

2020 POL 220: Introduction to American Politics, head TA for Dr. Sarah Staszak

POL 220: Introduction to American Politics, head TA for Professor Paul Frymer. ***Received the University Teaching Award this semester.***

2019 POL 300: Junior Paper Workshops, TA for Professor LaFleur Stephens-Dougan (race and ethnic politics) and Dr. Joanna Wuest (law and civil rights)

SKILLS

Technical:	R, RMarkdown, LaTeX, Git, Qualtrics, Word, Excel, PowerPoint
Languages:	English – Native speaker
	Spanish – Proficient
Quantitative:	Large-N datasets, surveys, experiments
Qualitative:	Interviews, participant observation, historical analysis

SERVICE

2026- Co-Founder of Future Americans Lab (Bucknell University)

2026- President of the Midwestern Political Science Association Latina/o Caucus

2025-26 Vice President of the Midwestern Political Science Association Latina/o Caucus

Faculty Advisor for Bucknell Student Voting Initiative

2024-25 Secretary of Midwestern Political Science Association Latina/o Caucus

2019	Co-founded Students of Color and Allies to cultivate a social space and support network for students of color and white allies at Princeton
2018	Graduate Student Representative for the Politics Department
2017-2019	Politics Graduate Representative for the Princeton Office of Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion

REVIEWS

American Journal of Political Science, Political Behavior, Perspectives on Politics, Journal of Race, Ethnicity, and Politics, Journal of International Studies, Political Research Quarterly